

Beth Rudden

Founder & CEO, Bast AI · Enterprise AI operator

OPERATING SCALE

Founder & CEO, Bast AI — built explainable AI control infrastructure and a core ontology engine without institutional funding; five patent filings, including two issued patents.

25 years building AI systems — trained 10,000+ data scientists across 175 countries.

Chief Data Officer, IBM's \$34B services division — led a \$450M AI P&L and grew it 20% in six months.

IBM Distinguished Engineer and Master Inventor — enterprise architecture, data lineage, provenance, and trustworthy AI at global scale.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Empressa AI25 — Named one of 25 Women Setting the Standard for Leadership in AI **(2026)**

WOW3 Unstoppable — Most Inspirational Women of Web3 and AI **(2025)**

Distinguished Data Scientist — Professional Certification, The Open Group **(2024)**

Bast AI awarded OEDIT Early-Stage Capital and Retention Grant **(2024)**

AI for the Rest of Us — Nominated #1 book to read in 2024 by Constellation Research

100 Most Brilliant Leaders in AI Ethics **(2023)**

IBM Master Inventor **(2019)**

Lifetime Achievement Award, IBM Academy of Technology

BOARD & ADVISORY

Board of Trustees, Maryville University

Advisory Board, Center for Advancing Safety of Machine Intelligence (CASMI), Northwestern University

Regulating AI — Expert

Cognitive World Think Tank Member

Conference Host, Enterprise AI World at KMWorld (2024, 2025)

WRITING & EXPERT CONTRIBUTIONS

["7 Ways to Spot Someone Who Thinks the AI Understands Them"](#) — most-read essay on Beth's Substack, 63K views **(2026)**

Cognitive World — Writer and Expert Contributor

VentureBeat — Writer and Expert Contributor

KMWorld — "Crossing the AI Chasm" featured column

[Substack](#)

[Medium](#)

[Google Scholar](#) — Publications

POLICY & PUBLIC ACCOUNTABILITY

Testified before the Colorado Senate Judiciary Committee on SB24-205, Colorado's landmark AI consumer protection act

Panelist alongside Colorado AG Phil Weiser at Silicon Flatirons on the regulatory future of AI

Speaker at ISP Symposium, Denver Museum of Nature & Science, with Congressman Joe Neguse on science communication ethics **(2023)**

SELECTED KEYNOTES & PUBLIC LEADERSHIP

2026

The Cynefin Exploratory — Eagle

One of three Eagles with Dave Snowden and Delia McCabe

2026

EarthX — Speaker

2025

Concordia Live

Gen. David Petraeus (Ret.) and Arvind Krishna in attendance

2025

Denver Council on Foreign Relations — Keynote

Followed by the Dean of the Korbel School, the Ambassador of the Middle East, and Representative of Taiwan

2024

SXSW EDU — AI's Leap: Shaping Tailored Learning

2024

Colorado Senate Judiciary Committee — SB24-205

Testimony on Colorado's landmark AI consumer protection act

2023

ISP Symposium, Denver Museum of Nature & Science

With Congressman Joe Neguse — ethics of science communication

2023

The Salzburg Dialogue (Austria)

2023

Global Female Leaders Economic Forum (Berlin)

SELECTED PODCASTS & INTERVIEWS

Masters of Scale Strategy Sessions — with Reid Hoffman and Rana el Kaliouby

Your data isn't exhaust. It's a belonging. — Untangled **(2026)**

Human Wisdom and Better Leadership — Authentic Ewe **(2026)**

Your AI Is Your Mirror, Not Your Oracle — Alistair Langer Podcast

Redefining AI Ethics: The Key Role of Explainability — DataStax Podcast

Artificiality Institute — Conversation **(2025)**

SELECTED PATENTS & PUBLICATIONS

30+ patents and publications as primary inventor/collaborator, spanning AI, NLP, knowledge graphs, data privacy, IoT, and semantic systems. Select patents donated to the Linux Foundation.

BAST AI

Five patent filings covering the core ontology engine, including two issued patents.

SELECTED IBM-ERA PATENTS

Ontology-driven Feature Engineering in Statistical Predictions

Hyperplane Optimization in High Dimensional Ontology

Generative Learning Paths for Autonomous Upskilling

Representation of Distributional Similarity in Semantic Graphs

Violation and Exception Life Cycle Management via Blockchain

Method to Identify and Prevent Privacy Violations in Consumer Devices

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

MA Anthropology — University of Denver (1998)

BA Classical Archaeology (Greek and Latin) — Florida State University (1996)

IBM APPOINTMENTS

Distinguished Engineer — IBM (appointed 2016)

Senior Technical Staff Member (STSM) — IBM (appointed 2012)

IBM Master Inventor (2019)

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

Distinguished Data Scientist — Professional Certification, The Open Group (2024)

Renewal of a profession Beth created and got accredited through The Open Group in 2018

L3 Thought Leader Certified Data Scientist, The Open Group (2018, recertified 2022)

BOOKS

AI for the Rest of Us (co-author) — Nominated #1 book to read in 2024 by Constellation Research

Julian Steward and the Great Basin (co-author and editor)